

LAUTARO CHITTARO

Department of Finance, Bocconi University
Via Roentgen 1, 20136, Milan, Italy

lautaro.chittaro@unibocconi.it [lautarochittaro.github.io](https://github.com/lautarochittaro)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Finance, Bocconi University 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Stanford University 2026

M.A. in Economics, Universidad de San Andrés 2016

B.A. in Economics, Universidad de Buenos Aires 2015

FIELDS

Financial Economics, Macroeconomics, Industrial Organization

WORKING PAPERS

Selection in Crisis Lending: Evidence from Chile's Government-Guaranteed Loans

with Cristián Sánchez

We study the long-run effectiveness of government-guaranteed loan programs implemented during recent crises. Using administrative and loan application data from the Central Bank of Chile, we track firm defaults five years after the COVID-19 shock. Our instrumental-variable estimates show that these loans postponed defaults for two years but did not reduce total defaults in the long run. Banks used private information to direct credit toward firms that would have been safer even without the program. To assess the welfare implications of the delayed defaults and banks' selection of safer firms, we build a dynamic model of heterogeneous entrepreneurs disciplined by our causal estimates. The program generated welfare gains 21% above its fiscal cost, with limited rents for banks and modest increases in aggregate risk-taking. Younger firms are the most cost-effective group to support, yet they are the least likely to be approved because their growth relies on leverage, increasing default risk. A budget-neutral redesign that raises guarantees for younger firms and reduces them for the rest could increase welfare by 6pp.

Asset Returns as Carbon Taxes

with Monika Piazzesi, Martin Schneider and Marcelo Sena

In frictionless financial markets, a carbon tax on energy users provides the same incentives as a *replicating return schedule* that depends on firms' emission intensities, defined as scope 1 emissions relative to enterprise value. We use this result to interpret pollution premia measured by recent empirical studies and conclude that markets currently provide only modest incentives. Replicating a serious carbon tax requires high returns in the right tail of the emission intensity distribution. With heterogeneous investors, such returns are not sustainable unless essentially everyone perceives large nonpecuniary costs from holding dirty capital. Substantial emission reductions can be achieved, however, when even a small share of investors perceive nonpecuniary *benefits* from owning clean electricity capital.

Pricing and Risk in Sovereign Green Debt: Evidence from Chile

with Marcelo Sena

We study the pricing of sovereign green bonds using Chile's pioneering green bond program and its cross-design issuance. Employing a panel of Chilean U.S.-dollar bonds, we estimate no-arbitrage pricing kernels for green and conventional bonds. The results reveal a declining greenium across maturities, driven by the higher interest-rate risk exposure of green bonds. We find no evidence of investor segmentation or liquidity differences between green and conventional bonds. Instead, we explain the observed pricing patterns through a representative-agent asset-pricing model in which investors derive nonpecuniary benefits from the real value of their green bond holdings. During high-inflation periods, as observed in our sample, the real value of green bond portfolios deteriorates, making the convenience service they provide scarcer and more valuable. This positive correlation between green convenience yield and inflation generates a risk premium that compresses the greenium especially at longer maturities, producing a downward-sloping greenium term structure.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Cost of Port Disruptions: Evidence from U.S. Containerized Trade

with Stephen Redding, Janet Stefanov, and Shoshana Vasserman

How costly are disruptions to activity at U.S. ports? To answer this question, we estimate a model of demand for importers of different types of products who choose which maritime port (if any) to use for their container imports. Our estimator leverages a nearly comprehensive panel of maritime imports to the U.S. between 2020 and 2025, linking customs records, granular GPS pings from container-shipping fleets, origin-destination-level shipping prices, and a number of additional data sources. Using variation in prices and processing times from localized slowdowns and disruptions at different ports, our model rationalizes importers' port choices as a function of daily origin-destination prices, travel time at sea and on land, port congestion, and sticky product-origin-destination preferences at the time of each shipment's observed departure. Our estimates allow us to predict the economic incidence of a short-term disruption at a subset of ports, such as a general strike. We use this to discuss the potential of different policies to support supply chain resilience.

PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

From Bad to Worse: the Economic Impact of COVID-19 in Developing Countries. Evidence from Venezuela

with Germán Caruso, María Emilia Cucagna, Luis Pedro España

Latin American Economic Review, 2021

Policy responses to COVID-19 affected the dynamic of economic growth and labor markets worldwide, hitting economically harder on developing countries. These policies involved economic lockdowns that included the shutdown of the main statistical exercises, making it almost impossible to assess the breadth and variety of their effects. Using a phone survey, this paper examines the impact of the quarantine implemented in Venezuela on labor market outcomes. The identification strategy exploits the exogenous variation in the severity of the lockdown in different regions of the country. The main result indicates a 16.5 percentage points reduction in employment, while in regions with severe lockdowns the reduction has been 13.8 p.p. larger. In particular, the self-employed and informally employed were hard hit by the lockdown. To cope with this effect, households sold their productive assets, reduced their savings, sought for alternative income sources and looked for help from relatives. This paper does not find a differential effect on the number of COVID-19 cases in more severe lockdown settings. Results are robust to endogenous migration and alternative specifications.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2026 ITAM, PUC-Rio, FGV EPGE, Universidad de los Andes, University of Miami, Boston College, Bocconi University, CEMFI, Universidad de Chile, EEA-ESEM, Universidad de Buenos Aires, Universidad Torcuato Di Tella, Banco Central de Chile
2025 NBER Summer Institute, Economic Fluctuations and Growth

OTHER POSITIONS

Department of Economics, Stanford University	2022-25
Research Assistant for Martin Schneider and Monika Piazzesi	
Graduate School of Business, Stanford University	2022-25
Research Assistant for Shoshana Vasserman	
World Bank, Washington DC	2020
Short-term Consultant	
Ministry of Production, Argentina	2017-20
Trade Policy Advisor	

TEACHING

Macroeconomics II (Ph.D.), Stanford University
Economic Forecasting (Undergrad), Stanford University
Macroeconomics I, II (Undergrad), Universidad de Buenos Aires
Industrial Organization (Undergrad), Universidad de Buenos Aires
National Accounts (Undergrad), Universidad de Buenos Aires

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Gale and Steve Kohlhagen Fellowship, Stanford University	2024
The Alejandro and Lida Zaffaroni Fellowship, Stanford University	2020-22

INTERNSHIPS & WORKSHOPS

Central Bank of Chile — Visiting Program	2024
Central Bank of Mexico — Summer Internship Program	2024
Princeton University — Macro, Money and Finance — Continuous Time Methods Workshop	2022

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

International Integration and Productive Development: New Policy Guidelines, 2018
with Juan Carlos Hallak — *Boletín Techint* 356 (in Spanish)
Exports, Bank Credit, and Repayment Capacity of SMEs in Argentina (2007–2016), 2020
Master thesis, Universidad de San Andrés

LANGUAGE

English (professional), Spanish (native), Italian (beginner)